

Debian 13 Trixie Post Install Guide: Essential Steps, Drivers, and Tweaks

 zihad.com.bd/posts/debian-13-trixie-post-install

September 3, 2025



Just installed Debian 13 Trixie? Follow this complete post-install guide to set up drivers, codecs, software, Flatpak, NVIDIA/AMD support, and system tweaks for a smooth Linux experience.

Debian 13 Trixie Post-Install Guide

Just installed **Debian 13 Trixie**? This guide will walk you through the essential post-install steps to get your system ready for daily use, including installing drivers, codecs, useful software, Flatpak apps, and tweaking system settings for optimal performance.

01. Add yourself to sudoers group

Check if you have sudo access. If you have then you can skip this step.

```
sudo  
whoami
```

If you don't have sudo access. Then -

- Switch to root

```
S  
L  
-
```

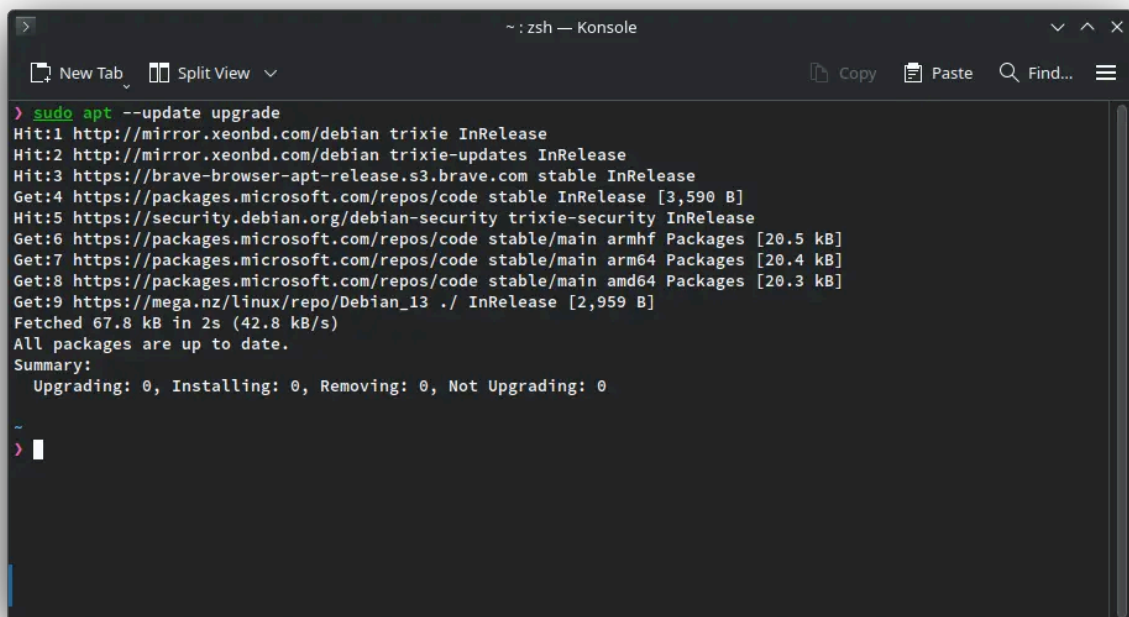
- Add your user to sudo group

```
usermod -aG sudo  
your_username
```

02. Update and upgrade system

From Debian 13 a new short way to update and upgrade your system.

```
sudo apt --update  
upgrade
```



```
> sudo apt --update upgrade  
Hit:1 http://mirror.xeonbd.com/debian trixie InRelease  
Hit:2 http://mirror.xeonbd.com/debian trixie-updates InRelease  
Hit:3 https://brave-browser-apt-release.s3.brave.com stable InRelease  
Get:4 https://packages.microsoft.com/repos/code stable InRelease [3,590 B]  
Hit:5 https://security.debian.org/debian-security trixie-security InRelease  
Get:6 https://packages.microsoft.com/repos/code stable/main armhf Packages [20.5 kB]  
Get:7 https://packages.microsoft.com/repos/code stable/main arm64 Packages [20.4 kB]  
Get:8 https://packages.microsoft.com/repos/code stable/main amd64 Packages [20.3 kB]  
Get:9 https://mega.nz/linux/repo/Debian_13 ./ InRelease [2,959 B]  
Fetched 67.8 kB in 2s (42.8 kB/s)  
All packages are up to date.  
Summary:  
  Upgrading: 0, Installing: 0, Removing: 0, Not Upgrading: 0  
  
~  
> |
```

03. Change sources to more readable format

One of the notable changes in Debian 13 Trixie is how the package management sources are handled. In previous Debian releases, users would typically manage their repositories by editing the `/etc/apt/sources.list` file directly. However, in Debian 13, the system now prefers the declarative `sources.list.d/debian.sources` format.

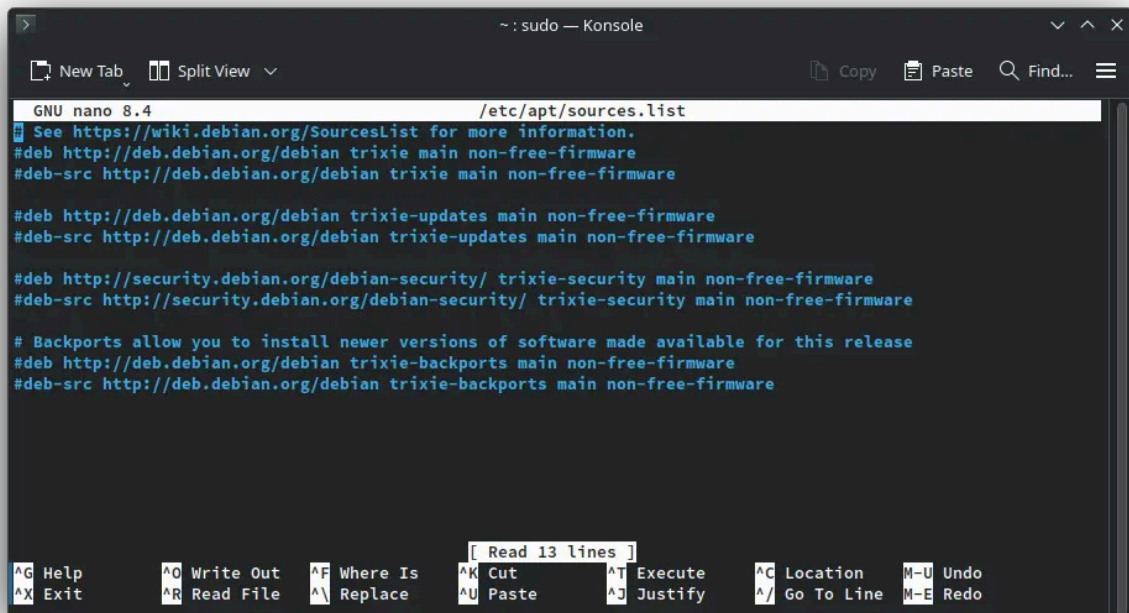
In Debian 13 Trixie, the old repository file `/etc/apt/sources.list` is no longer the main way to manage package sources. Before you start using the new `.sources` files, it's a good idea to comment out every line in the old file to avoid conflicts.

To do this, open the file with a text editor, for example:

```
sudo nano
/etc/apt/sources.list
```

Then, add a `#` at the beginning of every line. For example, change:

```
#deb http://deb.debian.org/debian trixie main contrib non-free
#deb http://deb.debian.org/debian-security trixie-security main contrib non-free
```

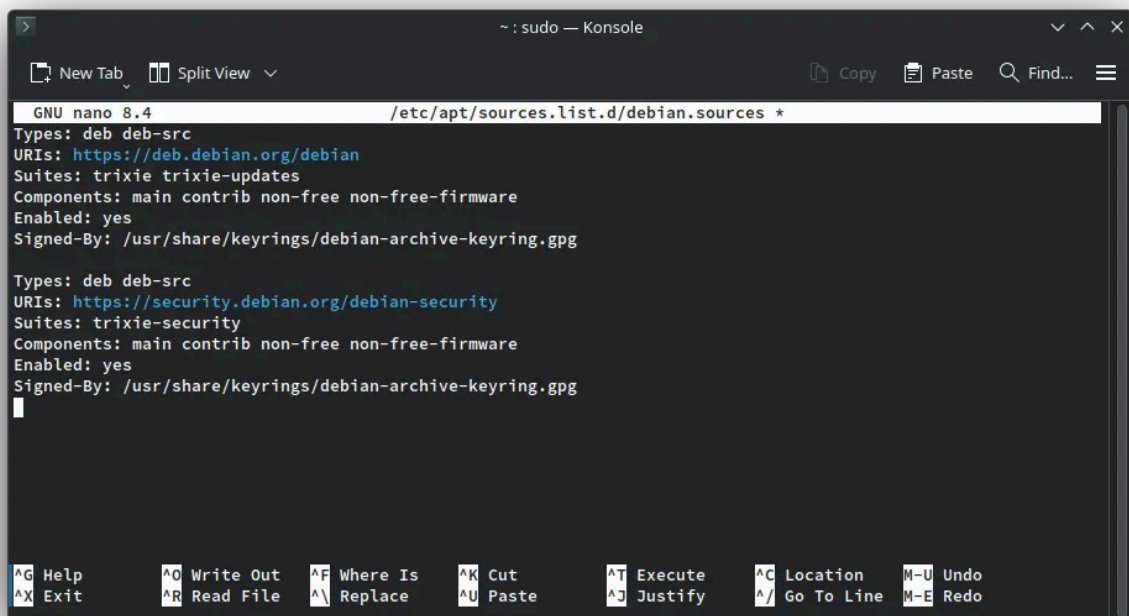


Create new sources file

Create new file in `/etc/apt/sources.list.d/debian.sources`. And put

```
Types: deb deb-src
URIs: https://deb.debian.org/debian
Suites: trixie trixie-updates
Components: main contrib non-free non-free-firmware
Enabled: yes
Signed-By: /usr/share/keyrings/debian-archive-
keyring.gpg
```

```
Types: deb deb-src
URIs: https://security.debian.org/debian-security
Suites: trixie-security
Components: main contrib non-free non-free-firmware
Enabled: yes
Signed-By: /usr/share/keyrings/debian-archive-
keyring.gpg
```



```
~: sudo — Konsole
New Tab Split View
Copy Paste Find...
GNU nano 8.4 /etc/apt/sources.list.d/debian.sources *
Types: deb deb-src
URIs: https://deb.debian.org/debian
Suites: trixie trixie-updates
Components: main contrib non-free non-free-firmware
Enabled: yes
Signed-By: /usr/share/keyrings/debian-archive-keyring.gpg

Types: deb deb-src
URIs: https://security.debian.org/debian-security
Suites: trixie-security
Components: main contrib non-free non-free-firmware
Enabled: yes
Signed-By: /usr/share/keyrings/debian-archive-keyring.gpg
|
^G Help      ^O Write Out ^F Where Is  ^K Cut       ^T Execute   ^C Location  M-U Undo
^X Exit      ^R Read File ^\ Replace   ^U Paste     ^J Justify   ^_ Go To Line M-E Redo
```

Note that we put non-free and non-free-firmware for more packages.

Now let's use the new short way to update and upgrade.

```
sudo apt --update
upgrade
```

04. Install Flatpak and Snap

On Debian you no longer have to be stucked on old applications. If you install them from flatpak or snap you will have latest versions of the softwares.

Flatpak

Let's install flatpak and flathub repo.

```
sudo apt install flatpak
flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub
https://dl.flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpakrepo
```

You can integrate flatpak with your existing software center. For GNOME

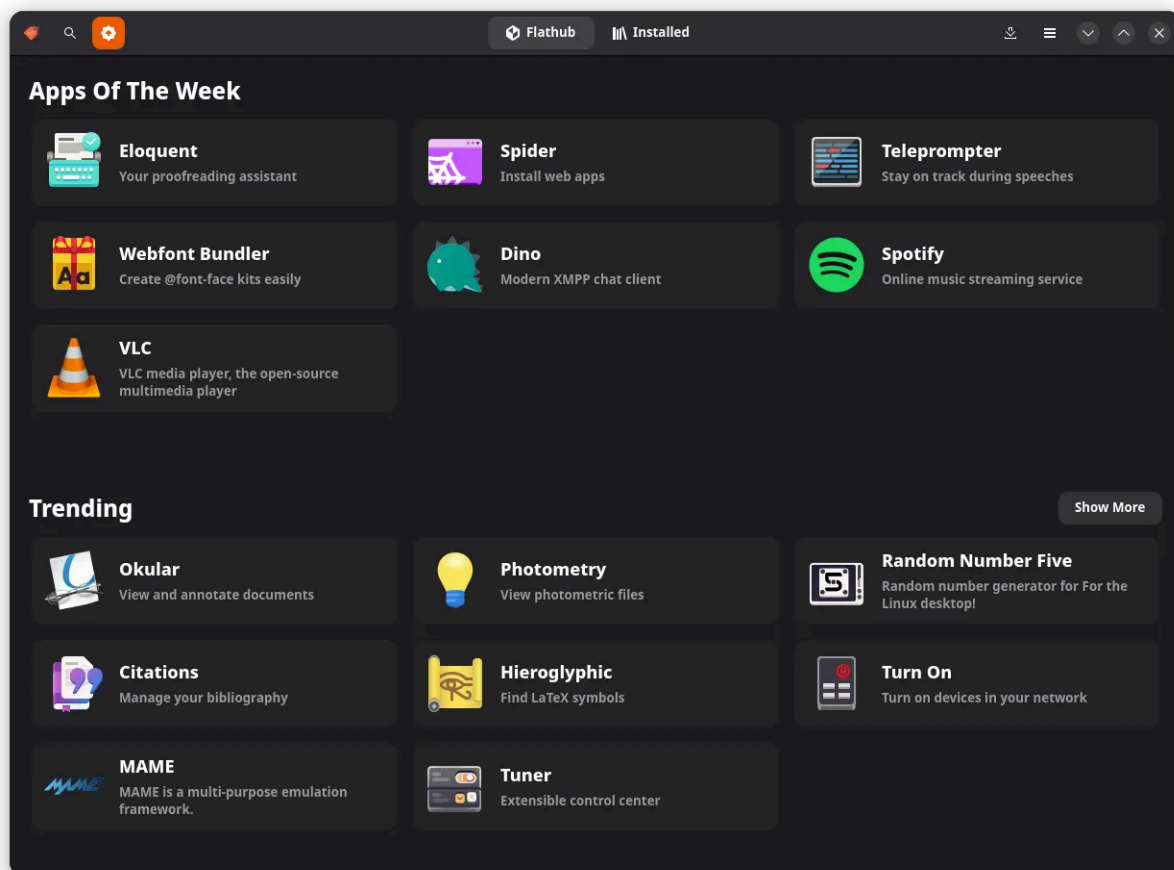
```
sudo apt install gnome-software-plugin-
flatpak
```

For KDE

```
sudo apt install plasma-discover-backend-
flatpak
```

But you can also have separate Flathub store called **Bazaar**.

```
flatpak install flathub
io.github.kolunmi.Bazaar
```



Install flatpak permission manager

```
flatpak install flathub  
com.github.tchx84.Flatseal
```

Snap

Install snap

```
sudo apt install  
snapd
```

You will need to reboot your system to properly integrate. If You have **Gnome Software** installed. You can install snap backend to manage snaps.

```
sudo apt install gnome-software-plugin-  
snap
```

If you're using KDE Plasma **Discover**

```
sudo apt install plasma-discover-backend-  
snap
```

You can install separate **snap store** too.

```
sudo snap install snap-  
store
```

05. Enable Magick SysRq - REISUB for Emergency reboot

We all face this issue in any machine. Sometimes the computer feels like to get stuck itself. In circumstances like that we can emergency reboot. For that we have to enable **SysRq key**.

Add the following line to the `/etc/sysctl.d/90-sysrq.conf` file:

```
kernel.sysrq  
= 1
```

In case your system freezes, you can safely reboot it using the **REISUB** sequence:

Hold down **Alt + SysRq** (Print Screen key).

While holding them, type the following keys in order: R, E, I, S, U, B.

The PC should reboot itself.

06. Microsoft Fonts and alternatives for “Cambria, Calibri”

```
sudo apt install ttf-mscorefonts-installer fonts-crosextra-caladea fonts-crosextra-  
carlito
```

07. Install Nvidia drivers.

Debian has [complete instruction](#) for installing Nvidia drivers. I will give you tldr.

Install **kernel headers**

```
sudo apt install linux-headers-  
amd64
```

If your NVIDIA GPU is older than RTX 2000 Series. Than install **proprietary** flavour of driver.

```
sudo apt install nvidia-kernel-dkms nvidia-driver firmware-misc-nonfree
```

If you have RTX 2000 and above. Use the **Open** flavour of driver.

```
sudo apt install nvidia-open-kernel-dkms nvidia-driver firmware-misc-nonfree
```

Restart your system after 5 mins to load the new driver.

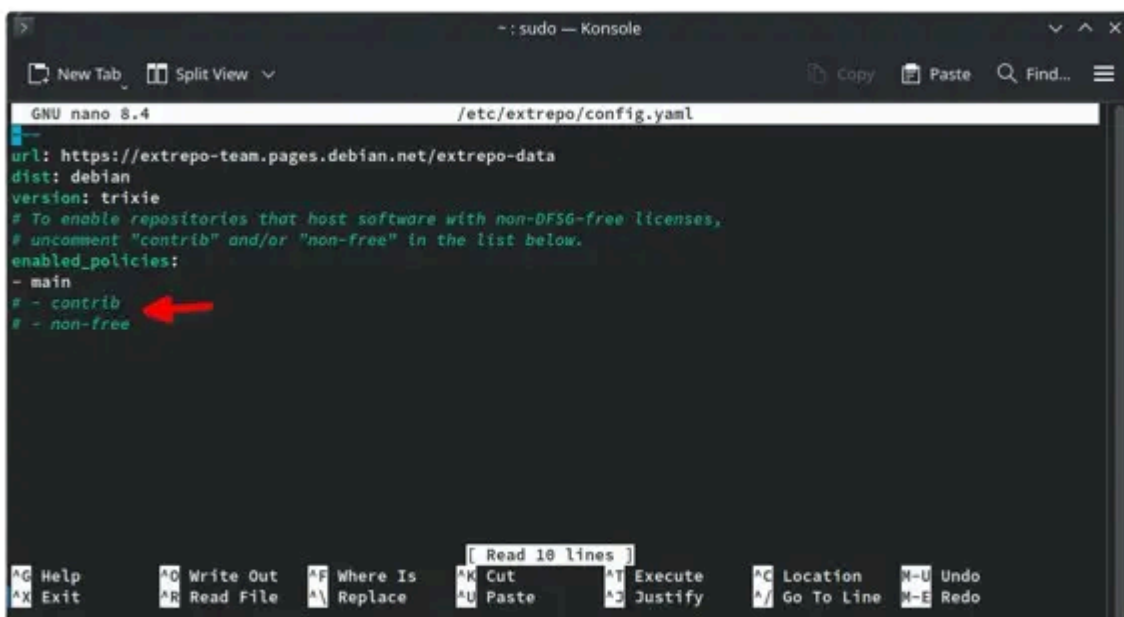
08. Install 3rd party apps using extrepo

Debian 13 has little advertised package called **extrepo**. This package can enables 3rd party repo easily. No more meddelling with curl and other scripts. The list of 3rd party apps that is available in extrepo apps [can be found here](#). You can see it has popular apps like **vscode**, **sublime text**, **spotify**, **Signal** etc. Note that this repos are managed by **debian salsa** team. So, we can say these are safe to use.

Let's install it:

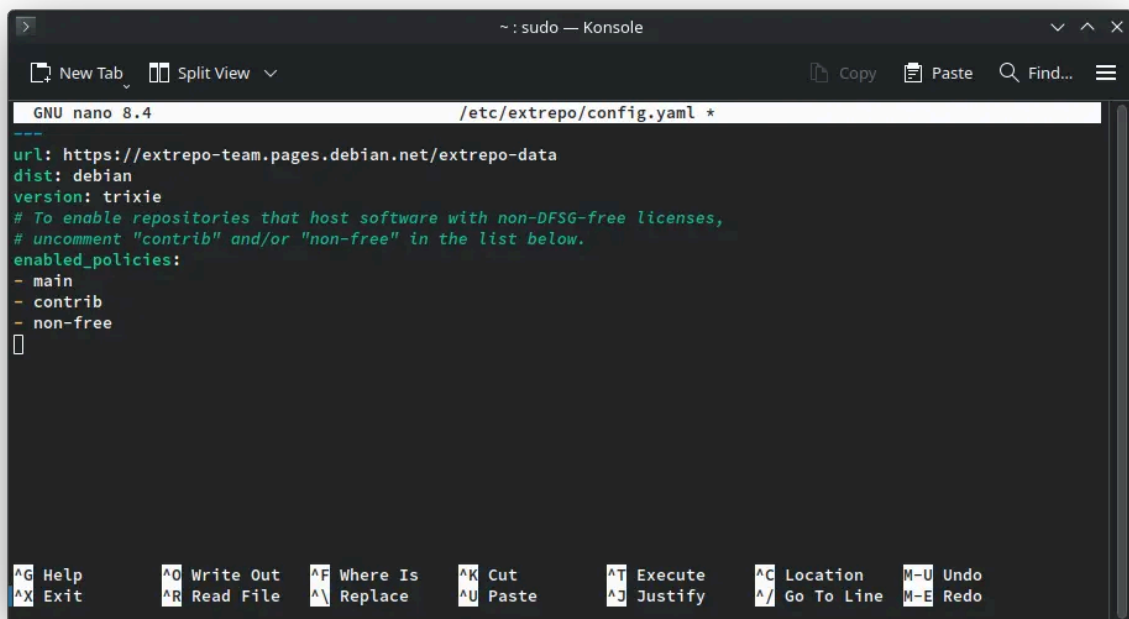
```
sudo apt install  
extrepo
```

Uncomment - contrib and - non-free lines in /etc/extrepo/config.yaml.



```
GNU nano 8.4 /etc/extrepo/config.yaml
url: https://extrepo-team.pages.debian.net/extrepo-data
dist: debian
version: trixie
# To enable repositories that host software with non-DFSG-free licenses,
# uncomment "contrib" and/or "non-free" in the list below.
enabled_policies:
- main
# - contrib
# - non-free
```


It should look like this:



```
GNU nano 8.4 /etc/extrepo/config.yaml *
url: https://extrepo-team.pages.debian.net/extrepo-data
dist: debian
version: trixie
# To enable repositories that host software with non-DFSG-free licenses,
# uncomment "contrib" and/or "non-free" in the list below.
enabled_policies:
- main
- contrib
- non-free
[]
```

You can list what apps available in extrepo

```
extrepo search | grep Found | sed 's/Found//g' | sed 's://g' |
sort
```

This little trick was mentioned by [a reddit user](#)

Install Brave browser, Google Chrome or Firefox using extrepo.

For Brave

```
sudo extrepo update
sudo extrepo search brave
sudo extrepo enable
brave_release
sudo apt --update upgrade
sudo apt install brave-
browser
```

For Chrome

```
sudo extrepo update
sudo extrepo search chrome
sudo extrepo enable google_chrome
sudo apt --update upgrade
sudo apt install google-chrome-
stable
```

For Firefox

```
sudo extrepo search
mozilla
sudo extrepo enable
mozilla
sudo apt --update
upgrade
sudo apt install
firefox
```

disabling is similar.

```
sudo extrepo disable
google_chrome
```

09. Install some apps recommended apps

These are some recommended apps that I install on every distro. You can pick and choose

```
sudo apt install \
  vlc \
  mpv \
  libreoffice \
  htop \
  fastfetch \
  torbrowser-
launcher \
  wget
```

I would suggest install 3rd party apps like Telegram, Signal, Discord from Verified flatpak or snaps repo.

10. Install qbittorrent: Playing with podman quadlets

This one is optional. But on every system I like to use qbittorrent using podman quadlets feature. On Debian 13 podman now has 5.4.2. What it does is it uses systemd to control podman. So, I can install and use qbittorrent webui.

Install podman

```
sudo apt install  
podman
```

pull qbittorrent-nox

```
podman pull docker.io/qbittorrentofficial/qbittorrent-  
nox:latest
```

Create this quadlet `~/config/containers/systemd/qbittorrent-nox.container`

put this inside:

```
[Container]  
Image=docker.io/qbittorrentofficial/qbittorrent-nox:latest  
  
AutoUpdate=registry  
PublishPort=58080:58080  
PublishPort=6881:6881  
PublishPort=6881:6881/udp  
Timezone=Asia/Dhaka  
  
Environment=PUID=1000  
Environment=PGID=1000  
Environment=QBT_WEBUI_PORT=58080  
  
Volume=qbittorrent-config:/config  
Volume=%h/Downloads:/downloads:Z  
  
User=root  
UserNS=keep-id  
Network=host  
  
[Service]  
Restart=on-failure  
TimeoutStartSec=900  
  
[Install]  
WantedBy=default.target
```

You can play with this config. Try changing the port. Here are [more quadlets](#) to play with.

Start the quadlet

```
systemctl --user daemon-reload  
systemctl --user start  
qbittorrent-nox
```

You can access the qbittorrent webui in `http://localhost://58080`

The initial user pass can be found using

```
podman logs -f systemd-  
qbittorrent-nox
```

With these post-install steps, your Debian 13 Trixie system is now fully optimized, secure, and ready for daily use. Explore, customize, and enjoy the stability and power of Debian. Happy computing!